

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

NETAS AND NETAJI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi recently pulled off a coup of sorts when he announced his plan to instal a 25-ft high granite statue of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose in New Delhi this August. The PM cast a hologram on January 23, the freedom fighter's 125th birth anniversary, at the chosen site near India Gate. West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee, seething over the Centre dropping her state's Republic Day tableau, which also featured Bose, isn't giving up on the freedom fighter though. She has announced the naming of three universities after Netaji, the erection of an Azad Hind monument, a museum of heroes from the freedom struggle and an annual celebration of Bose's birth anniversary. Bose was sometimes called the freedom fighter India forgot. No longer, it seems.

A Close Watch



Gujarat BJP president **C.R. Patil**, a former policeman, knows how to make a watertight case. His recently reconstituted party core group includes Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel but excludes former chief minister Vijay Rupani. The Patil-Rupani rivalry is an open secret in Gandhinagar. Patil has, however, retained Rupani in the parliamentary board, which will finalise election tickets for this year's assembly elections. Keep your enemies closer, as they say.

LORD OF THE FILES

M.K. Stalin waited an eternity to become Tamil Nadu chief minister. He won't be waiting as long for the verdict on his leadership. His first report card after eight months in office lists 2,619 out of 2,683 files cleared and government orders issued for 1,238 of 1,641 announcements. Stalin isn't stalling.



R SENTHIL KUMAR/PTI

–Sandeep Unnithan with Romita Datta, Amarnath K. Menon and Kiran D. Tare



RANE vs RANE

The family of India's longest serving MLA **Pratapsingh Rane**, 83, is split down the middle for the upcoming Goa assembly election. Rane is in the Congress and his son Vishwajeet is with the BJP. The BJP has nominated Vishwajeet in Valpoi, while his wife Divya will contest from Poriem. There she will likely go head-to-head with Rane's wife and her mother-in-law Vijayadevi. A not-so-classic *saas-bahu* tussle.

Reel Life Hero



I&B minister **Anurag Thakur** is hoping that resuscitating ghosts of films past will help him earn some electoral karma too. Come 2024 and 5,000 films and documentaries at the National Film Archives of India in Pune, that KPMG has been tasked with to restore and digitise, will be moved to a new building. The project was first launched in 2017 but was never completed. In 2019, it was taken forward under Prakash Javadekar, but later abandoned. Now, Thakur has infused Rs 600 crore into the endeavour and is making it his showcase project. Third time's the charm?